Teaching Statement

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I hold a Teaching Diploma in Science from the Lebanese University, a Master of Science in Computer Science from Maharishi University of Management, and a Ph.D. in Computer Science from Oakland University. This diverse academic background has provided me with a strong foundation in both the theoretical and applied aspects of computer science, significantly shaping my path as an educator. Beyond academics, my industry experience has also enriched my teaching philosophy, emphasizing the importance of preparing students to meet real-world challenges. This preparation is essential and critically important in an applied field like computer science. It is this combination of my diverse academic background and extensive professional experience that has shaped my teaching philosophy and approach.

Teaching Philosophy and Approach

At the core of my teaching philosophy is the belief that education should serve as a bridge between theoretical knowledge and practical application. The role of the educator is to effectively communicate complex theoretical concepts to students with clarity. I am convinced that true mastery of a theoretical topic is demonstrated by the ability to explain it clearly to anyone, using the right words and examples. Driven by this conviction, I strive to make complex, abstract concepts accessible to students by relating them to real-world challenges and experiences. For instance, when teaching web programming, I draw on my expertise in research and cybersecurity to highlight the importance of secure coding practices. I build on my solid theoretical foundation in cybersecurity and my practical experience to provide my students with well-rounded knowledge, explaining security concepts and developing relevant examples that demonstrate the importance of security best practices in protecting distributed applications from malicious exploitation in today’s digital landscape.

As an Assistant Professor of Computer Science at Maharishi International University, I have had the privilege of teaching a wide range of courses, including computer organization and architecture, low-level programming, fundamental and advanced Java programming, modern programming practices and web programming. I also teach cybersecurity, software engineering, DevOps, microservices, and CI/CD. My approach to teaching these subjects is student-centered, focusing on active learning, hands-on projects, and fostering a collaborative learning environment. I encourage my students to think critically, solve problems creatively, and apply their knowledge in practical settings.

In my teaching, I strive to create a supportive and engaging learning environment that develops students both intellectually and personally. I believe that education should prepare students not only to master technical concepts but also to cultivate the soft skills essential for success in academia, professional practice, and life as a whole. I emphasize teamwork, communication, adaptability, and problem-solving as integral parts of every course.

Equally important is guiding students to reflect on the ethical implications of their work as computer scientists. I encourage them to understand the trust users place in them when allowing their code to run on personal devices, and the responsibility that comes with safeguarding that trust. I also emphasize that even small design choices—such as improving software performance or optimizing algorithms—can have a meaningful impact on energy consumption and the environment. By adhering to best practices, maintaining ethical standards, and striving for excellence, students not only advance their own success but also contribute to a more sustainable and responsible technological future.

My role as an educator extends beyond the classroom. I am deeply committed to mentoring and advising students, guiding them through their academic and professional journeys. I take pride in helping students identify their strengths, set goals, and navigate challenges, all while fostering a growth mindset. Whether through office hours, one-on-one meetings, or group discussions, I am dedicated to supporting my students' academic, professional, and personal development.

Curriculum Development and Continuous Improvement

The field of computer science and technology, whether at the level of hardware or software, is ever-changing. Staying at the forefront of technological advancements is essential to equipping my students with the latest and most relevant information for the job market. I am constantly researching software development methodologies, new technologies and current industry trends. Additionally, I actively participate in curriculum development and continuous course improvement to ensure that the computer science courses I teach remain current with evolving industry trends and technological advancements. My ongoing professional development includes performing research and attending conferences, engaging in online forums, and continuously learning about new technologies and methodologies. This commitment enables me to incorporate the latest tools and techniques into my courses, providing students with a cutting-edge education that prepares them for the rapidly evolving tech industry.

Impact and Vision

My ultimate goal as an educator is to empower students to become knowledgeable, innovative, and ethical professionals who can contribute meaningfully to the field of computer science. I am passionate about nurturing the next generation of computer scientists who are not only technically proficient but also capable of addressing the ethical and societal implications of their work.

Looking forward, I am excited to continue refining my teaching methods, exploring new ways to integrate emerging technologies into the curriculum, and contributing to the academic community. I am committed to making a lasting impact on my students, helping them achieve their full potential and preparing them to face the challenges and opportunities of the future.